Assessment Checklist

A free, plant-agnostic verification of competency form from ICAP

This checklist is free to use and adapt. It covers the steps common to verifying competency on any mobile plant — the parts that do not change between an excavator and a haul truck.

It is a genuine working form, not a sample of one. Use it, put your own logo on it, and change what does not suit your site.

1 · CANDIDATE, ASSESSOR AND MACHINE			
Candidate name		**Employee / ID no.**	
Employer / site		**Position**	
Assessor name		**Assessor qualification**	
Plant class		**Make and model**	
Date		**Location / conditions**	

2 · BEFORE YOU START

Confirm each of these before the assessment begins. An expired item is resolved first.

	Photo identification sighted		Site induction current
	Licence or ticket current (where required)		Medical or fitness for work current
	Candidate confirms fit for work today		Candidate understands what is being assessed
	Conditions suit the assessment		Right of appeal explained

3 · OBSERVATION RECORD

Observe in real time. Follow the checklist in order and record what you see as it happens — not afterwards, and not from memory.

Task step / performance criteria	Critical	Y / N / NA	Assessor comments
A · Pre-start and access			
Completes the documented pre-start inspection in full, in order	CRITICAL		
Identifies defects and reports them before operating	CRITICAL		
Confirms the machine is fit for service, or removes it from service	CRITICAL		
Maintains three points of contact on access and egress			
B · Operation and communication			
Fastens and correctly wears the seatbelt	CRITICAL		
Confirms park brake applied before start-up			
Selects the correct radio channel and makes positive calls	CRITICAL		
Complies with site speed limits and road rules at all times	CRITICAL		
Maintains safe separation from plant, light vehicles and personnel	CRITICAL		

Task step / performance criteria	Critical	Y / N / NA	Assessor comments
Stops work and reports when conditions become unsafe	CRITICAL		
C · Hazard identification and awareness			
Identifies the hazards in the work area before starting	CRITICAL		
Establishes and maintains any required exclusion zone	CRITICAL		
Confirms services, structures and overhead hazards are identified	CRITICAL		
Responds appropriately to changing ground, weather or visibility	CRITICAL		
Recognises blind spots and does not rely solely on cameras	CRITICAL		
D · Shutdown and park-up			
Parks in a safe, designated location on stable ground	CRITICAL		
Applies park brake and lowers attachments to the ground	CRITICAL		
Shuts down following the manufacturer's procedure			
Isolates and tags out where required	CRITICAL		
Completes post-operation checks and reports any defects			

A "No" against any step marked CRITICAL means Not Yet Competent, regardless of how the rest of the assessment went. Critical steps are the ones where getting it wrong causes serious harm rather than lost production.

4 · KNOWLEDGE QUESTIONS

Ask every question. The candidate does not need to use the same words, but must cover the elements in the model answer.

#	Question	Model answer — must include	Critical
1	What defects must be reported immediately, and what do you do about the machine?	Any defect affecting safe operation — brakes, steering, tyres, lights, seatbelt, guarding, leaks, warning devices. The machine is not operated and the defect is reported straight away.	CRITICAL
2	What do you do if conditions become unsafe during your task?	Stop work, make the area safe if possible, and report to the supervisor. Do not continue and adapt on your own.	CRITICAL
3	What are the steps in the site's isolation and tag-out process?	Identify energy sources, shut down, isolate, apply personal lock and tag, verify zero energy, then work. Reverse to restore, removing your own lock last.	CRITICAL
4	What do you do if you witness a near miss?	Make the area safe if possible, report it to the supervisor immediately, and complete the site reporting process.	CRITICAL

Record responses:

#	Response — record the substance of what the candidate said	S / NS
1		
2		
3		
4		

5 · DECISION

	COMPETENT — all steps satisfactory, including every critical step
	NOT YET COMPETENT — gap and reassessment plan agreed

Basis for the decision — what the evidence showed:

6 · FEEDBACK AND SIGNATURES

Strengths observed:

Areas requiring development, and what happens next:

Candidate signature		**Date**	
Assessor signature		**Date**	

7 · WHAT THIS CHECKLIST DOES NOT COVER

Everything above applies to any mobile plant. What it leaves out is the part that changes from machine to machine — and that is where most assessments are won or lost.

Not in this free checklist	Examples
Machine-specific pre-start	Quick hitch checks, rocks between duals, engine bay build-up
Machine-specific operation	Pushing to the windrow, retarder use on descent, load charts, control pattern
Machine-specific hazards	Slew crush, tip head edges, body-up while moving, articulation pinch points
Machine-specific questions	The ones that reveal whether an operator understands the machine
The governance layer	Policy, assessor appointment, appeals, currency tracking, mapping, RPL

8 · WHERE TO GO FROM HERE

If you need	Look at
VOC forms across your fleet	ICAP VOC Template Pack — a self-contained form for every plant class on your fleet
A full assessment system	ICAP Assessment Toolkit — governance, core instruments, plant overlays
Tools for your supervisors	ICAP Supervisor Pack — allocation, hazards, coaching, handover
To build your own tools	ICAP Assessment Tool Development — coaching plus templates
Someone to run assessments	Talk to us about on-site assessment and assessor coaching

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Free to use and adapt within your own organisation. This is a generic tool — set your own site figures and satisfy yourself it meets your obligations before relying on it.